

SOME GLADIATORS REFUSED TO EAT BEFORE THE GAMES—NOT EVEN DISHES LIKE THIS ASPARAGUS AND QUAIL—IN CASE THEY WERE TOO FULL TO FIGHT.



One last supper

Gladiators came to town the day before the games began. They were guests of the wealthy patron (known as the *editor*) who was giving the show. That night, at a grand banquet held in the fighters' honor, the public watched them eat. It was a chance to "eye up" the gladiators and

decide who looked like they'd fight well and who wouldn't. The gladiators knew that this might be the last food they'd ever eat. Some made the most of it and stuffed their faces—can you blame them? A few couldn't stomach the food and spent the evening pleading with members of the public to take messages to their families.

GAMES BEGAN WITH ANIMAL FIGHTS. THIS FIGHTER FACES A LION AND A LEOPARD.

